ERIC HOWIE

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Startup Operations Leadership | MedTech Innovation | Capital Strategy | Regulatory Execution | Scalable Growth | GTM Strategy

Drives operational excellence and venture-scale growth through capital strategy, agile execution, and cross-functional leadership across regulated tech, financial and healthcare environments. Brings extensive experience building startups from the ground up, launching FDA-ready products, and scaling innovation with capital efficiency. Distinguished by a unique career trajectory spanning two decades each in C-level finance and MedTech roles, offering an unparalleled strategic perspective on navigating deeply regulated industries, from SEC and SOX compliance in finance to FDA regulations and Quality Management Systems in MedTech.

- **Venture Capital Strategy**: Raised $10M+ across multiple rounds by aligning investor fit, refining pitch strategy, and guiding regulatory milestones through early-stage trials.
- **Clinical Innovation Leadership**: Conceived and launched non-contact vital monitoring technology with clinical-grade accuracy for COPD patients, now advancing toward FDA clearance.
- **Pioneering Trial Execution**: Led largest known COPD clinical trial worldwide (w/out CRO involvement), relocating to London to oversee design and on-site execution of 18K+ nights of live patient data collection across an international clinical research effort.
- **Regulatory Leadership**: Built robust regulatory frameworks from the ground up to ensure smooth company operations and stimulate growth in both the FDA and SEC environments.
- **Strategic Growth & Integration**: Boosted regional AUM from $400M to $3.2B through targeted acquisitions, team expansion, and streamlined post-merger integration.
- **Founder-to-Exit Success**: Established and scaled two companies from inception through acquisition or investor transition, driving operational maturity and institutional growth.

Key Skills: Startup & Venture Growth, Strategic Planning, Product Lifecycle Management (PLM), Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Medical Device Development, Board Management, M&A Integration, Infrastructure Buildout, Remote & Distributed Teams, Market Entry Strategy, Data-Driven Decision Making, Cloud Infrastructure, Commercial Readiness, Risk Mitigation, Stakeholder Engagement, Budget Optimization, P&L Management, Cost Reduction, Resource Planning & Allocation, Product-Market Fit, Sales Enablement

Professional Experience

Founder & CEO/COO, Life Detection Technologies (LDT), Sunnyvale, CA 08/2014 – 04/2025

Founded and scaled a venture-backed MedTech startup from concept to FDA readiness, overseeing all company operations, product development, and GTM execution. Formed board of directors, oversaw all VC communications and investor reporting, and introduced agile frameworks to drive ROI-focused growth with lean teams and capital efficiency. Transitioned to COO in April 2024 to support new leadership, continuing to lead execution across engineering, ML, clinical trials, regulatory strategy, and commercialization.

- **Startup Formation & Infrastructure Buildout**: Transformed a personal medical challenge into a venture-scale startup, assembling the founding team, recruiting engineering talent, and building all core systems, product infrastructure, and operational workflows.
- **Venture Capital Strategy & Investor Relations**: Secured $10M+ across multiple funding rounds by aligning capital strategy with investor priorities, guiding pitch refinement, and steering execution toward high-value regulatory and clinical milestones.
- **Product Innovation & Lifecycle:** Launched a proprietary non-contact vital sign monitoring device with clinical-grade accuracy; directed full lifecycle from concept through engineering, EVT/DVT, QMS setup, and regulatory readiness for FDA clearance.
- **GTM Strategy:** Defined GTM strategy by analysing five verticals (baby monitor, hospital beds, home health, automotive, COPD) and product-market fit; selected segments based on strongest payer ROI, adoption potential, and clinical value alignment.
- **Clinical Trial Execution**: Designed and led the largest known COPD clinical trial, w/out CRO involvement, including study architecture, securing institutional partners, and managing international trial operations while ensuring regulatory compliance.
- **Machine Learning Optimization**: Achieved 500% improvement over best-in-class early warning systems, leading a cross-border machine learning team; leveraged 18,000+ nights of trial data to train predictive models for COPD exacerbation detection.
- **Regulatory Readiness & FDA Strategy**: Developed QA infrastructure, selected vendors, and prepared technical documentation for hardware, firmware, and software; positioned the company for FDA submission and approval.

- **Cost Reduction & Hardware Reengineering**: Reduced device cost by 80%+ (from $15K to $2.3K) by eliminating complexity and redesigning the architecture; launched roadmap to cut costs an additional 70% through lean iteration.
- **Agile Execution & Capital Efficiency**: Embedded agile delivery models across engineering, clinical, and operations; extended runway and maximized capital efficiency by aligning team sprints to regulatory and clinical milestones.
- **IP Strategy & Patent Portfolio**: Secured 20+ global patents (10 issued in the U.S. as of July 2025 with the remainder issued or pending globally) by leading IP strategy, legal filings, and competitive defence, preserving core startup technology.
- **Team Building & Leadership**: Built and retained a high-performance team with 4–5 year average tenure by fostering a culture of shared purpose, mission alignment, and iterative leadership using agile principles.
- **Talent Strategy & Team Structure Optimization:** Optimized headcount by balancing in-house, contract, and offshore roles based on lifecycle stage and ROI; prioritized high-impact W2 hires and selectively offshored ML functions.

Partner & Managing Director, Beacon Pointe (Wealth) Advisors, San Jose, CA 04/2011 – 12/2017

Led all operational functions and P&L oversight for Northern California territory, managing a cross-functional team of 15 and supporting firmwide expansion initiatives across multiple U.S. markets. Spearheaded M&As, team growth, post-merger integration, and backend infrastructure optimization to scale service delivery for high-net-worth clients and institutional partners.

- Achieved 5x AUM growth in Northern California by leading strategic acquisitions and optimizing integration workflows; preserved partner autonomy while embedding operational standards to retain top advisors and drive scalability.
- Contributed to enterprise-wide AUM expansion from $400M to $3.2B by co-leading national M&A strategy; sourced, negotiated, and integrated new territories including Texas, Arizona, and Boston to accelerate market entry.
- Increased profit margins from 10% to 30% by modernizing backend systems and scaling operational infrastructure; enhanced trading efficiency and leveraged internal platforms to reduce advisor overhead and improve throughput.
- Expanded and preserved relationships with TD Ameritrade, Charles Schwab, and Fidelity to support advisor flexibility and client preference, ensuring seamless platform integration and expanded service offerings.
- Improved post-merger integration outcomes by developing modular onboarding playbooks tailored to high-performing partner firms; enabled seamless transitions while minimizing cultural resistance and attrition risk.
- Maintained a 94%+ client retention rate year over year by prioritizing relationship continuity, personalized service models, and operational consistency throughout rapid expansion and organizational change.
- Doubled regional advisor headcount and scaled cross-functional operations by aligning team growth with strategic P&L goals; executed recruitment, onboarding, and performance oversight for wealth advisors, partners, and client service roles.
- Ensured full SEC and FINRA compliance while scaling multi-market operations by embedding regulatory oversight into daily advisory workflows; secured a clean audit record with no violations during tenure.
- Enabled national brand elevation and strategic growth by institutionalizing the M&A playbook, aligning operational strategy with expansion goals, and collaborating with executive leadership to support firmwide market penetration.

Founder, Excelcia Financial Group (Acquired by Beacon Pointe), San Jose, CA 07/2004 – 03/2011

Founded and scaled Excelcia from inception into one of Northern California's largest independent RIAs, overseeing all business development, operations, and client strategy. Created a high-trust brand through direct sales, operational discipline, and relationship-driven growth, ultimately attracting and negotiating a successful merger with Beacon Pointe. Led the full lifecycle of the transaction, aligning strategic objectives, positioning the firm for acquisition, and executing a seamless operational transition.

- Directed all business development and operational functions, securing early traction through grassroots outreach, reputation building, and persistent market engagement despite limited institutional support.
- Positioned Excelcia as an ideal strategic partner for Beacon Pointe, achieving scale, profitability, and operational maturity that aligned with acquisition goals and expanded regional market share post-merger.
- Built a growth engine from the ground up that combined relationship-based sales, operational discipline, and consistent client satisfaction with 96% client retention YOY, laying the foundation for successful M&A outcomes.

Founder, Williams Howie and Associates, Santa Clara, CA 06/2002 – 06/2004

Founded Williams, Howie & Associates as a lean-market entry to validate financial advisory models during a period of market volatility, growing the firm amid the post–dot-com crash downturn in Silicon Valley.